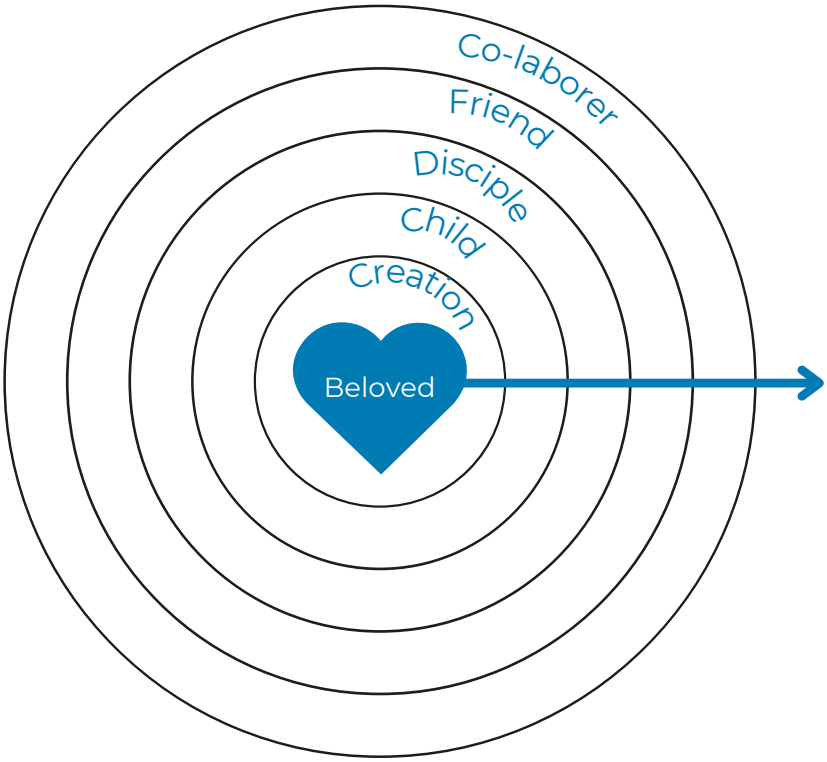
Empower

IDENTITY:
BEING BEFORE DOING



There is no hierarchy of identities as followers of God. In fact, because we are in relationship with a trinitarian God, we have multiple relationships with God simultaneously. What is important is not the achievement of new "identity qualifiers" but rather the reality that we are beloved before we do anything for God.

***Beloved*:** Before anything we do and after everything we have done, we are deeply loved by God.
(Jeremiah 31:3, Zephaniah 3:17, John 3:16, Romans 5:8)

***Creation*:** Whether we choose to follow Jesus as our Lord and savior or we remain in rebellion, no one may escape the fact that they are a creation of the mighty and eternal creator God. And if a creation, then a bearer of His image.
(Genesis 1:27, Psalm 139:13-16, Isaiah 45:6)

***Child*:** The very first identifier God gives us as beloved creations is child. This is exclusive to those that put their faith in Jesus, who won on the cross the reconciliation of all people to God, and it requires no effort on our part to receive this title.
(John 1:12, Romans 8:15, 1 John 3:1)

***Disciple*:** As a child of God, he invites us to not only learn from Him but imitate Him and His life. To learn how to live like a son, we have to learn from the Son. As students of a mighty rabbi, we must seek to study His word and heed His instruction.
(Matthew 4:19, John 6:68-69, Galatians 2:20)

***Friend*:** As we follow our mighty creator, father, savior, and teacher, we grow in intimacy with Him as a friend. It is hard to live in friendship with a creator and father who you do not obey first.
(Exodus 33:11, Psalm 25:14, John 15:15)

***Co-laborer*:** Shared Goals are relational glue. It is apparent and significant that God does not need man's help, but desires the relationship of laboring together in the "family business" of making disciples. He chooses us to help accomplish His advancement of His kingdom here on earth.
(1 Corinthians 3:9, Ephesians 2:10, Colossians 1:28-29)

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